



AMNESTY INTERNATIONAL AOTEAROA NEW ZEALAND

PROJECT CLOSE-OUT REPORT

Human Rights DAO · Cardano Project Catalyst · Fund 13 · Project 1300018

PROJECT DETAILS

Name of project: Human Rights DAO — Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand

Project URL (IdeaScale / Catalyst): <https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-use-cases-concept/amnesty-international-dao-and-human-rights-token-proof-of-concept-10-million-global-membership-community>

Your project number: 1300018 (Fund 13)

Name of project manager: Gareth Farry, Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand (technical lead: Razali Samsudin, Manifest Studio)

Date project started: March 2025

Date project completed: June 2026 (Final Milestone 4)

CHALLENGE KPIS AND HOW THE PROJECT ADDRESSED THEM

The project was funded under the Fund 13 *Cardano Use Cases: Concept* challenge, which sought credible, real-world concepts that demonstrate the value of building on Cardano, backed by evidence of feasibility and benefit to the ecosystem. The project addressed the challenge's aims as follows:

- **A viable, evidenced concept.** Carried a public-interest governance concept the full distance — from research and a whitepaper, through token design, to a working prototype tested by real users — rather than stopping at a paper idea.
- **Demonstrated feasibility on Cardano** through a working MVP, on-chain governance, smart contracts, and successful pilot testing with real participants.
- **Clear ecosystem value.** Produced an open-source, public-interest reference implementation — a humanitarian use case the wider Cardano community can learn from and build on.
- **Real-world validation.** Evidenced demand and usability through a four-region pilot, showing the concept works for people who are not crypto-native.

PROJECT KPIS AND HOW THE PROJECT ADDRESSED THEM

PROJECT KPI	TARGET	RESULT AND STATUS
Milestones accepted by Catalyst	4 of 4	4 of 4 delivered (M4 in review)
Budget delivered across milestones	₺150,000	₺125,000 released; ₺25,000 (M4) in review
Open-source codebase published	Yes	Published to the public repository
Pilot participants (structured feedback)	≥30	36, across four regions (NZ, AU, EU, Asia)
Usable without a tutorial	Yes	Achieved — 83% rated the experience smooth/intuitive
Would use a refined version	≥60%	78%
Substantive governance engagement	Signal sought	61% raised substantive governance concerns
Results shared across Amnesty + Cardano	Yes	This report, the close-out video, and network channels
Academic / peer outputs	≥1	1 working paper + 3 accepted 2026 conference papers

Targets at or above a percentage were set by the project team where the challenge did not specify a numeric threshold.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS (COLLABORATION AND ENGAGEMENT)

- A working, tested MVP on Cardano that supporters with no prior blockchain experience could successfully use with minimal onboarding.
- A four-region pilot (Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, the European Union and Asia) with 36 structured participants, returning strong usability and demand signals.
- A dual-token model validated under real use, with a non-transferable governance credential that keeps influence tied to contribution rather than capital.
- An open-source, public-interest reference implementation contributed to the Cardano ecosystem.
- Scholarly engagement carrying the work beyond the project: a working paper and three accepted 2026 international conference contributions (Aarhus, Bangkok, Toronto).
- Sustained engagement across Amnesty's movement and the Cardano community, with a documented stakeholder feedback log.
- Public dissemination of project outcomes through Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand, the public GitHub repository, conference presentations, the Catalyst platform, and the final project completion video.

KEY LEARNINGS

- Lead with the mission, not the mechanism — participants told us to drop the word “decentralised”; the technology should be felt, not seen.
- Recognition is the engine — the earn-and-see-your-standing loop is what made participation feel real.
- The hard problem is governance design, not code — concentration of influence, fairness of access, misaligned coordination, and representation of lived experience are the priorities.
- Inclusion has to be designed in, with multiple equally-valued paths to participation.
- A rights tool must run on sovereign, inspectable infrastructure it can trust.
- What we did not finish, and now scope into the next phase: a production-grade privacy-preserving identity layer, a full independent security audit at scale, and cross-jurisdiction legal review.

NEXT STEPS FOR THE PRODUCT OR SERVICE DEVELOPED

The pilot successfully demonstrated the concept; the next phase is about delivering it at the standard a human rights movement deserves. Planned next steps:

- Bring the intelligence layer home to local, open-weight AI under the movement's control, rather than third-party services.
- Solve privacy-preserving identity on Cardano using Atala PRISM and Midnight, proving unique personhood without surveillance.
- Give participants and Amnesty sections hardware and communications they own and can repair.
- Place structured deliberation upstream of on-chain voting, and add explicit safeguards against concentration of influence.
- Commission an independent security audit, penetration test, and adversarial governance simulation before any wider deployment.
- Begin cross-jurisdiction legal review across a defined set of priority jurisdictions.
- Anchor the rights and settlement layer on Cardano, and keep the layers above it open and portable.

This is public-interest infrastructure rather than a commercial product. The team is seeking next-phase funding from a deliberately diversified base — open-internet and digital-rights funders, Amnesty's own pathways, and further Cardano-ecosystem support — so that no single source controls the work.

FINAL THOUGHTS

This pilot set out to answer one question: can a global human rights movement use decentralised governance to give its supporters a real, rewarded voice? The answer is yes, with conditions — and the conditions are now a clear agenda for future development rather than open questions. We are grateful to the 36 pilot participants whose thoughtful and constructive feedback shaped both this evaluation and the project's future direction, to the Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand and Cardano communities, and to Project Catalyst for backing the work.

The project leaves behind an open-source repository, a tested prototype, a governance framework, and a clear roadmap for future development.

LINKS AND RESOURCES

- **Close-out video (public):** <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3yMPATiJ4mg>
- **Project repository (open source):** <https://github.com/Sugarlicks/AmnestyDAO-Token>
- **Project page:** <https://amnesty.org.nz/dao/>
- **Catalyst proposal (Fund 13, #1300018):** <https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-use-cases-concept/amnesty-international-dao-and-human-rights-token-proof-of-concept-10-million-global-membership-community>
- **Full pilot impact & close-out report, whitepaper, tokenomics model, and pilot dashboard:** available in the project repository.